

EMEM: A Content-Addressed, Verifiable Earth-Memory Protocol

An Earth observation that survives an agent handoff.

emem gives a sampled or derived observation a reusable reference. The next agent recovers its value, location, acquisition time and processing recipe, then checks the evidence. Where no observation exists, emem signs an absence and its reason, not a zero.

A compact citation keeps the observation traceable across agents and time. Design goal: encode in orbit, decode in AI’s reasoning with emem.

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From observation to the next agent

Observe	Locate	Record	Hand off	Resolve	Check	Continue
Satellite or sensor Keep the source scene.	Location · product · time Lookup identity	Canonical record + CID Batch attestation	Pass the reference MCP · REST · A2A	Retrieve the same record Recover its provenance.	Hash · bind · sign · source If one fails: refuse.	Reason with cited evidence Carry the reference onward.

1 Does agent B act on a corrupted handoff?

The same corruptions, handed over five ways.

Agent A cites a satellite reading. A relay changes the evidence. Agent B acts on it, declines it or uses the genuine record.

Agent A cites	handoff	relay	Agent B	B did not act on corrupted evidence agents, pooled Claude	declined	used the genuine record
 Agent A reads NDVI 0.4709 and cites it Sentinel-2A L2A, 25 Sep 2026 outlined: the 10 m pixel the record names RGB from recorded grids	prose The Sentinel-2 L2A NDVI for the 10 m cell at Keylong, Laha...	relay or faulty signer changes: value cell time band source derivation stale state signature pixel	B reads the text	22 / 276	22	0
	JSON { "about": { "field": "Keylong, Lahaul (32.57126 N, 77.03448...		B reads the fields	112 / 276	106	6
	retrieved text (RAG) Field log, Keylong, Lahaul (32.57126 N, 77.03448 E), cell ...		B retrieves a passage	56 / 276	56	0
	opaque id record ref obs-7d1c44		B fetches the sender's record	134 / 288	88	46
	emem reference emem:fact:defi.zb572.xoso.zb1ec:oj5ceccile62uvm6hedpuk6...		B resolve re-hash place / time / band signature log recompute source re-read	300 / 300	264	36

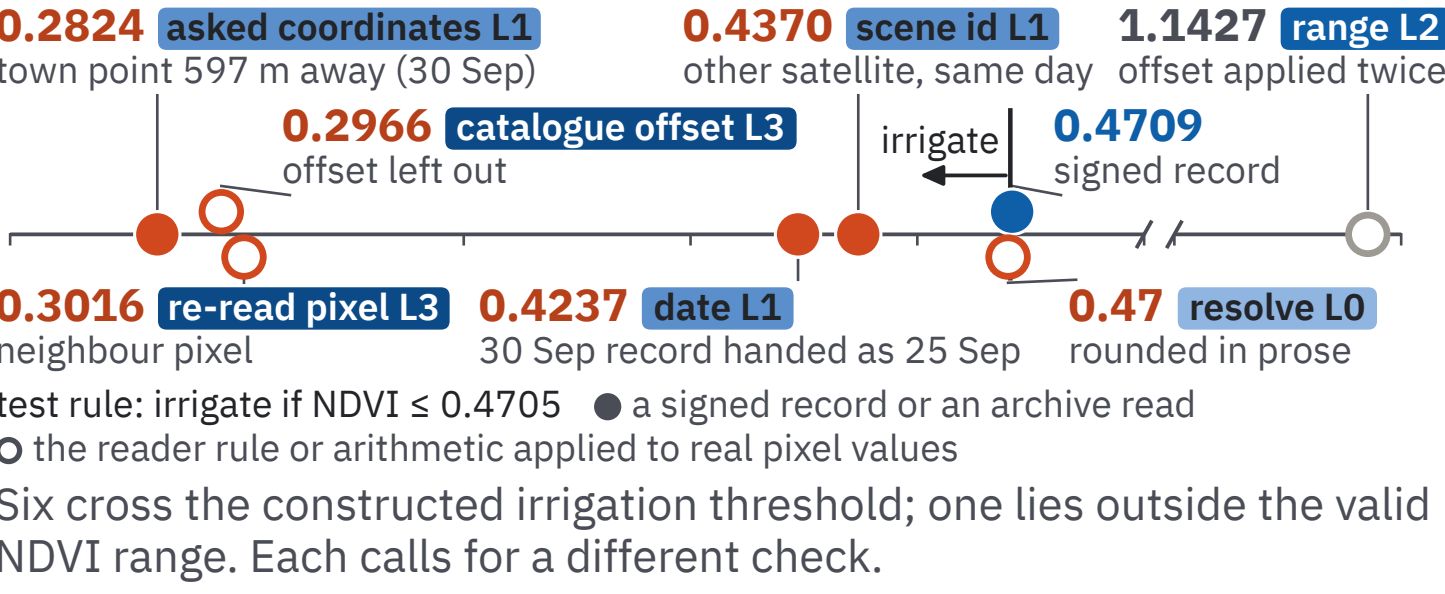
Across the 23 shared items, agents with an emem reference did not act on 276 of 276 corrupted handoffs (240 declined, 36 used the genuine record); with an opaque id, 122 of 276; in prose, 22 of 276.

By design, Earth data stays on the encoding device in orbit; its signed record and reference are downlinked into the AI’s reasoning (SAT-042 harness, not flown).

2 How does a value change between agents?

One NDVI, eight values

We varied one Keylong NDVI by scene, date, place, pixel and arithmetic.



3 Where did the evidence change?

A changed value needs a cause

Between acquisitions, the surface, sensor, location or processing can change.

CONCEPTUAL CHANGE MODEL

$$\Delta Z = \Delta_{env} + \Delta_{sensor} + \Delta_{geo} + \Delta_{encoder} + \epsilon$$

Δz : change in readout. The terms list possible causes (environment, sensor, geolocation, encoder, residual), not measured shares.

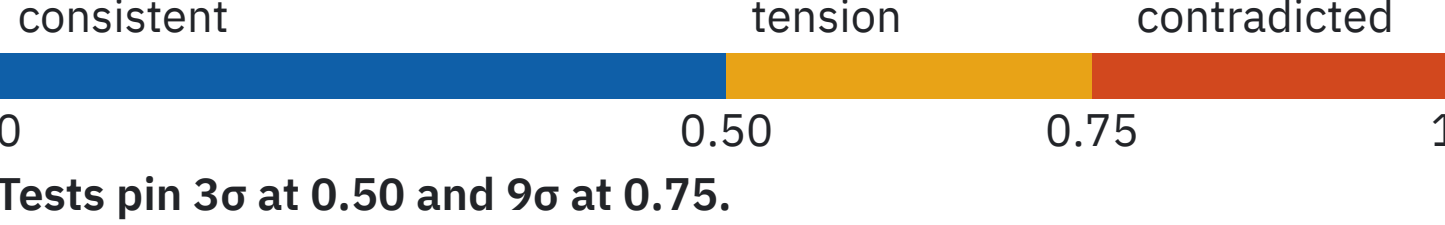
IMPLEMENTED HEURISTIC · DRIFT-ANCHOR SCORE

$$d = |x - a| \text{ for finite } x, a \text{ and } 0 < \sigma < \infty$$

$$r = d / (3\sigma); s = r / (1 + r)$$

Invalid σ : $s = 0$ if $d = 0$; otherwise $s = 1$ (fail-closed).

x : output · a : anchor · σ : anchor uncertainty



Tests pin 3σ at 0.50 and 9σ at 0.75.

Score boundaries: consistent < 0.50; tension < 0.75.

This score is an uncalibrated heuristic: it measures disagreement with one anchor, not a cause. SAT-042 uses it in the execution harness.

7 What does a checked reference establish?

The record, not physical truth

CHECKABLE	NOT ESTABLISHED
Record bytes + content identity	Sensor accuracy
Declared cell, band, time	Entity identity
Attestation signature	Physical truth
Declared derivation	Decision correctness
Recorded history / as-of	Source quality: inherited

Run the corresponding checks; a content address alone is insufficient.

Record checks establish properties of the cited record. A source re-read adds evidence about the sampled pixel; sensor accuracy remains inherited.

FULL TRACE · 30 SEP 2026

Token · **record** · **source pixel**

accept if BLAKE3(b) = cid & cell(b) = cell(token) & NDVI(DN(b)) = value & COG(row, col) = DN(b) & Ed25519(a) & leaf in STH & STHgeo.qa prefix of STH

Without emem software, a 698-line script (Python stdlib, blake3, cbor2, pynacl) checked 15 links (17 checks) in 17.9 s, all verified. Grey: what must still be trusted after each check.

1-3 content address 1,115 B hash to the fact_cid; one flipped mantissa bit gives mu5x2ciks... · still trusted: BLAKE3's and the verifier's code

4-5 cell binding hashed cell = token cell = the lat/long the derivation used · the cell rule

6-7 derivation scene id, DNs, catalogue and offset are inside the bytes; NDVI recomputed bit-for-bit · argument order read from emem's code

8-9 upstream the STAC item matches the scene; the COG pixel at col 9098, row 9443 reads B08 3502, B04 1900 · STAC carries no checksum

10-11 server signature emem.dev's Ed25519 receipt over the request id, time, cells and returned fact_cids · shows what emem.dev served, not that the value is right

12-14 public log entry 2,457,078 is in the 2,556,451-entry log, consistent with the root geo.qa co-signed · geo.qa is also run by Vortex AI

15 signing key the signing key is published in did:web, JWKS and DNS TXT for emem.dev · Web PKI, DNS without DNSSEC

Links 1-5 and 12-14 fit in a 4,906-byte file that repeats 9 checks with networking disabled (unshare -rn); a 1-bit tamper, a wrong cell or a wrong key fails it.

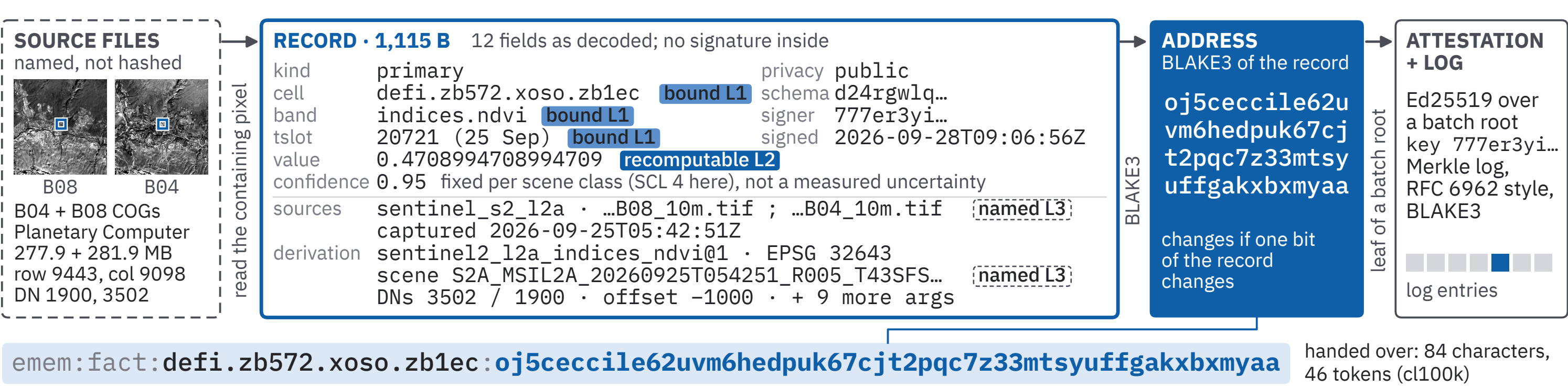
THE CONTRIBUTION
Checkable observation handoff EO evidence that travels between agents, checked by the receiver down to the source pixel. Content hashes (IPFS), signed logs (SCITT) and provenance (PROV) already exist. emem adds typed EO references and a source re-read, which caught a wrong pixel that hashing, signatures, logs and recomputation had passed (panel 6).

4 What exactly is handed over?

A compact reference to an exact record

The receiver uses an 84-character reference to fetch the record and its evidence.

INSPECT THE RECORD The 1,115 bytes behind the main example, decoded.



emem:fact:defi.zb572.xoso.zb1ec:oj5ceccile62uvm6hedpuk67cjt2pqcz733mtsuyffgaxkxbmyaa

BLAKE3 identifies the 1,115-byte record. Its fields name the source files, sampled point and derivation; a batch signature covers the record address. Source-file hashes are absent from this record.

THE MEMORY, AS CODED · fact.rs, cbor.rs, geo.rs, recall.rs, attest.rs, translog.rs, emem-attest

```
fact name f = (kind, cell, band, tslot, value, unit, confidence, sources, derivation[fn key, args], privacy, schema_cid, signer, signed_at)
b = CBOR(f), declaration order, NaN as f97e00, -0 as +0; fact_cid = base32(BLAKE3-256(b)); token emem:fact:cell:fact_cid:cell
lat_q = round((lat+90)/180*(2^1-1)), lng_q = round((lng+180)/360*(2^2-1)); pitch 8.583e-5° = 9.52 × 8.06 m here
tslot = floor(unix / 86 400) (20721 = 25 Sep 2026); key (cell, band, tslot); as of; argmax (signed_at, cid) over signed_at ≤ t
sign R = Merkle(sorted fact_cids); attestation = Ed25519(PreimageV1("attestation"))(R, registry, schema); a fact carries no signature
log leaf = BLAKE3(0x00 || BLAKE3(CBOR(attestation))), node = BLAKE3(0x01 || 1 || i); RFC 6962 shape
receipt sig = Ed25519(BLAKE3("emem.preimage.v100" || request_id || served_at || primitive || cells || fact_cids || merkle))
```

5 Which changes can the receiver detect?

Checks can continue back to the source

Resolve L0 · Re-hash L0 · Bind L1 · Recompute L2 · Re-read L3

agent bars: three Claude models pooled, 1 Oct 2026

	prose	JSON	RAG	opaque id	emem checks	first check that refuses
B acted on corrupted evidence	unaffected	refused	not applicable			
M2 seen in production	the only check that stops it	flips the decision				
G0	nothing altered: accepted everywhere, never refused					
M1	stated value moved by 1 ULP	0/12	0/12	0/12	3/12	C L0
M2	stated value rounded to "0.47"	6/12	6/12	1/12	12/12	C L0
M8	value 0.45, re-encoded and re-hashed	0/12	6/12	6/12	6/12	F L0
cell M4	record cited for another cell	5/12	12/12	6/12	6/12	E L1
M9	cell changed inside the record, re-hashed	5/12	1/12	6/12	6/12	F L0
time M10	tslot changed to look current, re-hashed	0/12	6/12	6/12	6/12	F L0
band M6	a record for another band handed over	0/12	12/12	6/12	10/12	E L1
source M11	source scene id changed, re-hashed	0/12	0/12	0/12	0/12	F L0
derivation M12	offset changed, value recomputed, re-hashed	0/12	1/12	0/12	4/12	F L0
M14	value (0.46) disagrees with the signed DNs	0/12	6/12	0/12	6/12	H L2
stale / current M5	an older record handed over as current	0/12	11/12	6/12	11/12	E L1
M16	a second signed version shown only to B	0/12	6/12	6/12	6/12	G L0
signature / id M3	1 ULP changed inside the served bytes	0/12	0/12	0/12	0/12	D L0
M7	token miscomputed by one character	n/a	n/a	n/a	12/12	C L0
M13	value 0.45 under the forger's own key	0/12	6/12	0/12	6/12	F L0
source pixel M15	DNs read from the pixel 10 m south	0/12	0/12	0/12	0/12	I L3
entity M17	same record; A meant another entity (out of scope)					none

B did not act on corrupted evidence

deterministic receiver, same corruptions

0/15 0/15 3/16 16/16

resolve L0 hash L0 binding L1 signature L0 log L0 recompute L2 re-read L3 D to I are cumulative: each adds one check

Bars: B did not act on it (declined, or used the genuine record), n 12 (6 Haiku 4.5, 5 Sonnet 5.5, 1 Opus 5.5 runs); squares: deterministic ceiling. Totals pool 23 to 25 items, 1 Oct 20

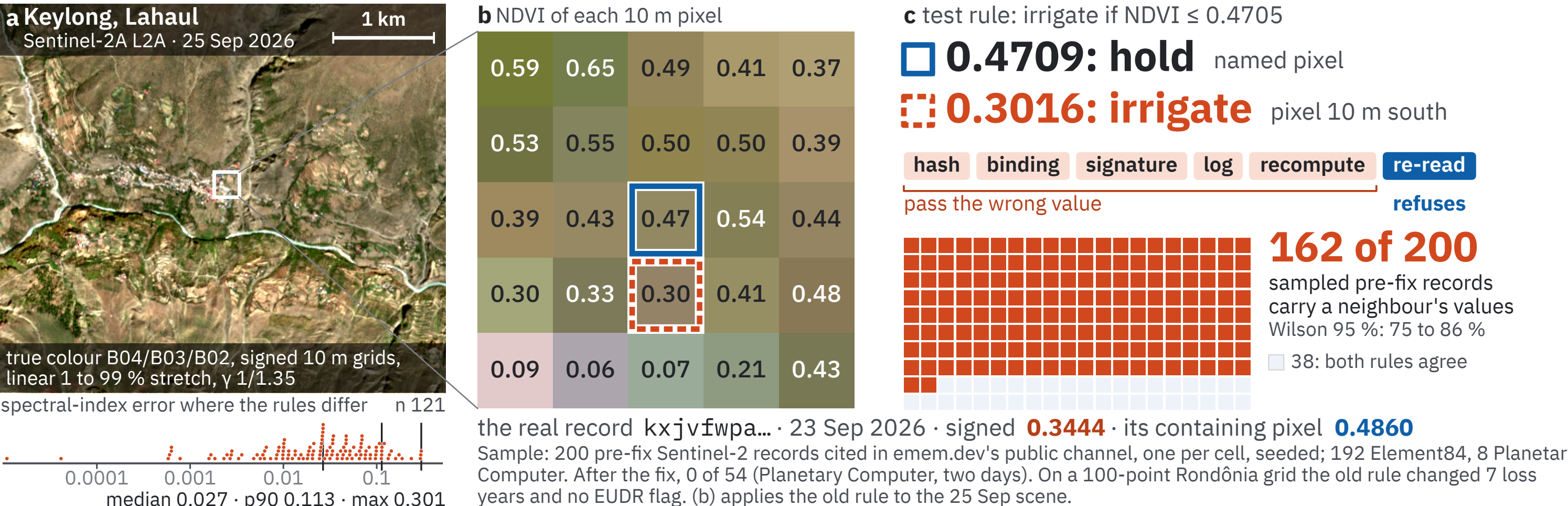
Three further signer errors (offset, same-day scene, unit) pass checks D to I; metadata checks catch them.

Deeper checks expose different corruptions. Agents with an emem reference decided correctly on 71 of 72 genuine controls and declined one.

Each agent bar is 12 runs of one item; totals pool 23 items per condition (24 for the opaque id, 25 for emem). JSON and an opaque id caught some changes from their fields. On the live pre-fix record, agents acted 4 of 4 times uninstructed, 2 of 4 with resolve-and-bind instructions and 0 of 4 with a source re-read.

6 A valid record can preserve a wrong source read

NDVI = (DN₈ − DN₄) / (DN₈ + DN₄ + 2o), o = −1000 (product offset)



12 Use emem. Carry the evidence forward.

ChatGPT · @emem plugin "Signed facts about real places" Enable emem; paste a token.	Claude · Directory plugin / MCP "hand another agent a token it can check offline" Resolve from chat or terminal.	Dify · Marketplace plugin "Shared memory for AI agents. One address per fact, one signature you check." Referent Lock / EUDR workflows	GitHub MCP Registry · Server listing "Satellites for AI." Install MCP server	ClawHub · OpenClaw plugin listing "Shared, signed and content-addressed memory of the physical world..." Install the OpenClaw plugin.	CONNECT
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